2024 上

录

我是瑞斯拜四级

四六级我只看瑞斯拜

Stay hungry, Stay foolish

阅读

课程观看 B 站：我是瑞斯拜

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写在前面

各位亲爱的同学，四级考试词汇量要求是 4200-4500 左右，但是即使你把所有的大纲词汇都记住了，你还是会遇到生词，这很正常。 我在之前学习英语的时候，每每遇到生词就会记中文意思在旁边，积累的单词多了可以用英文来记新单词的含义。久而久之遇到的次数多了单词就记住了。我在课堂上会在讲到阅读的方法，但是这些方法都是基于单词的基础的。所以请大家一定要重视单词，勤动手记笔记。笔记不用单独准备笔记本，记在讲义上就行。

如果你词汇量低，可以先刷一刷词汇课 35 讲。再来听课会轻松得多。

阅读部分在英语四级考试中分为三个题型

SectionA 选词填空-这个题 10 个题只占 5%的分数，我们最后来冲刺 5 篇。

SectionB 长篇阅读-段落匹配 10 道题 10%的分数，学会方法较为简单，在课程上会讲系统的做题方法。由于页数较多不建议全部打印，讲义中仅展示一篇。大家需要刷题可以按照自己的需求打印。

SectionC 仔细阅读 10 道题 占 20%的分数 ，我们的课程是这个部分为主。

做题顺序：先做 sectionC，再做翻译，再做 sectionB，最后 SectionA

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TEXT1

One of my bad habits is saying"busy"when people ask me how I'm doing.Sometimes it's because I actually am busy,but other times it's because that's what I think I'm supposed to say.That's what important people say.That's what people who get promoted say.But working long hours doesn't drive better results. Never taking a vacation won't lead to a promotion.So why are we so proud to talk about how busy we are all the time?

In 2016,researchers from Columbia,Harvard,and Georgetown conducted a study to figure it out.They found busy people are perceived to be of high status,and interestingly,these status attributions are heavily influenced by our own beliefs about social mobility.In other words,the more we believe that one has the opportunity for success based on hard work,the more we tend to think that people who skip leisure and work all the time are of higher standing.

That's why we feel like we have to appear busy,and there's a real perception that if someone is knee-deep in meetings,emails,and stress,then they're probably a big deal.This culture of busyness is making it hard for

employees to find work-life balance.According to a recent study,one in five highly engaged employees is at risk of burnout (精疲力竭).

Personally,I'm going to stop saying "busy"when people ask me how I am.It sounds self-righteous(自以为是的)and sets the wrong tone.Phrases like "I have limited access to email 'and "it'll respond as soon as I get back” sound like you're being held against your will from working as opposed to making the most of your time off.

That's why we recently launched the Out of Office Email Generator,a free tool you can use before your next long weekend or trip.You can share loud and proud that you won't be checking email until you're back. Managers need to think twice about emailing their teams on the weekend and talking about how busy they are. Leaders should take time off themselves and encourage employees to do the same.

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46.What is a reason for the author to be in the habit of saying "busy"when asked how he is doing?

A) He just follows successful people's example.
C)He thinks everyone should be devoted to work.
B)He is actually proud to be fully occupied.
D)He believes busyness ensures accomplishments.

47.Why do we tend to think that busy people are of high status?
A)Our status can be attributed to our social mobility.
B)We hold the belief that hard work leads to success.
C)Our own opportunity for success never comes easily.
D)We find few people of high status have time for leisure.

48.What do we learn about the culture of busyness from a recent study?
A)It places employees in endless meetings,emails and stress.
B)It compels some 20%of employees to appear always busy.
C)It distorts many employees' belief of what a satisfying life is.
D)It does much harm to many busy employees' well-being.

49.What do such utterances as “I have limited access to email” sound like according to the author?
A)One is too busy to check all emails in time.
C)One is forced by circumstances to stop working.
B)One is opposed to the prevailing work culture.
D)One is simply enjoying their time off work.

50.Why did the author and his colleagues launch the Out of Office Email Generator?
A)To enable busy employees to spend less time checking emails.
B)To ensure employees as well as employers truly have time off.
C)To stop managers from talking about how busy their teams usually are.
D)To encourage both employers and employees to answer emails promptly.

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阅读答案：ABDCB

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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Text2

Female employees consistently pay lower airfares than men do for the same flights because they tend to book earlier.

We compared the airfare paid by employees in the same position within a company for the same class of travel and used a common statistical technique to account for other factors that might affect differences in airfares.We found that women paid on average $18 less per ticket than their male colleagues.

Further investigation allowed us to conclude that this gap is largely explained by the fact that women tended to book earlier than men,1.8 days on average.

We wanted to determine what was causing these gender differences in booking business trips so we tested a variety of possible explanations,such as women choosing to plan ahead or male frequent travelers being inclined to book late.None of these explained away the gender gap,so we applied data collected from surveys that express consumer preferences that play a central role in economic decisions,such as patience and risk avoidance.

We found that only the concept of "negative reciprocity"-in which an employee who feels unfairly treated engages in negative behaviors,such as spending their company's money less carefully-explains these differences.The surveys showed men tend to exhibit more of these negative behaviors than women.This isn't to say that all men engage in these behaviors—or that booking relatively late is a sign of abnormal behavior.It only means that the gender gap disappears when we plug in the negative reciprocity variable.

Prior research on negative reciprocity among workers found that it can result in lower employee motivation, business performance and workplace morale(士气)and culture.

Our results show another way these negative behaviors can manifest themselves,like in airline bookings,

and add to evidence that women are less likely to engage in them.

Companies spend significant sums of money on business travel.While that $18 difference per ticket may seem small,it adds up.Our analysis suggests early booking by women can translate into savings of $1 million a year for a large multinational company with 20,000 regular travelers.

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51.What did the author's team conclude about the gender difference in airfares from their further investigation?

A)It is largely attributed to women booking earlier than men.

B)It is largely explained by women's choosing cheaper flights.

C)It is mainly accounted for by male employees' readiness to pay more.

D)It is due to the fact that women care more about their company's money.

52.What did the researchers want to determine by testing a variety of possible explanations?

A)What made male frequent travelers book air tickets late.

B)What caused women to plan ahead in booking business trips.

C)What motivated women to book cheaper flights.

D)What accounted for the gender gap in airfares.

53.What happened when the negative reciprocity variable was taken into account?

A)Both men and women were found to engage in negative behaviors.

B)Neither men nor women viewed booking late as a bad behavior.

C)The gender difference in airfare expenses no longer existed.

D)The gender gap tended to narrow to a significant degree.

54.What did prior research on negative reciprocity among workers find?

A)It can do more harm to the workplace than to employees.

B)It contributes to the male-female divide in the workplace.

C)It proves to be counterproductive in a number of ways.

D)It can result in increasing labor-management conflicts.

55.What does the author emphasize about their analysis in the last paragraph?

A)It can help companies increase their savings significantly.

B)It can duly contribute to companies' business performance.

C)It can translate women's booking practice into men's behavior.

D)It can enhance large multinational companies' competitiveness.

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阅读答案：ADCCA

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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text3

Having a rival can keep you committed to achieving your goals and enhance your overall performance.But before you go out and find an entrepreneur to out compete,it's important to understand and avoid the traps that often come with rivalry.After all,competitive rivalry can also hinder effective decision-making and increase your willingness to take risks,behaviors that can ultimately hurt your venture's success.

Finding someone you're committed to out competing can be a great way to stay focused on your goals and push your venture to the next level.But when you're intently focused on outperforming your rivals,you may begin to develop a“win-at-all-costs”mentality that causes you to ignore how you achieve success.One group of researchers,for example,examined the link between rivalry and unethical behavior.They found that when people compete against their rivals,they are more willing to behave unethically to win.But such behavior may stain your reputation and strain relationships important to your success.One way to avoid this trap is to stop and reflect on what's important.While outperforming your rivals may provide short-term benefits,the loss of your integrity will have long-term consequences.

One reason having a rival can enhance your venture's performance is that it creates a level of excitement that drives you to work harder.But this eagerness to win may also hurt your venture's success,particularly when it causes you to make impulsive,insensible decisions.But it's possible to avoid such costly mistakes by making

a habit of engaging in critical thinking,such as considering opposing viewpoints and conducting cost-benefit

analyses,especially for those decisions that are complex and can determine the future of your venture.

The sense of eagerness that comes with having a rival can not only cause you to make poorer decisions, but it can also lead you to take greater risks that put your venture in peril.One way you can overcome the risk- inducing effects of rivalry that stand to endanger your venture's success is to remain attentive to your emotional state and actively monitor how such feelings are affecting your decision-making.

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46.How can competitive rivalry benefit entrepreneurs according to the passage?
A)By enabling them to out compete other entrepreneurs.
B)By enabling them to make their venture a success.
C)By helping them to reach long-term goals.
D)By helping them to stay goal-oriented.

47.What is one of the traps entrepreneurs may often fall into when competing with rivals?
A)They may adopt strategies that are bound to ruin their venture.
B)They may resort to unethical means to outperform their rivals.
C)They may be too eager to succeed while ignoring the huge labor cost.
D)They may be intently focused on winning at the current market level.

48.What are entrepreneurs advised to do to avoid traps that often accompany rivalry?
A)Deliberate on what really matters.
C)Estimate the long-term consequences.
B)Prioritize reaping immediate benefits.
D)Reflect on what successes are achievable.

49.How can entrepreneurs avoid making impulsive and insensible decisions?
A)By engaging themselves in critical reasoning.
B)By developing a habit of keeping their integrity.
C)By criticizing themselves for previous poor performances.
D)By refraining from being too excited about their successes.

50.How can entrepreneurs overcome the risk-inducing effects of rivalry?
A)By paying close attention to their current performance.
B)By taking steps that stand to endanger their rivals'success.
C)By monitoring how their decision-making impacts their mentality.
D)By keeping their emotions in check to avoid making poor decisions.

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阅读答案：DBAAD

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随写区

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Text4

A multitasker is one who can perform two or more tasks effectively at the same time,which—apart from the obvious differences—is similar to what a computer does.The concept does indeed come from the realms of technology,where it is used to refer to an operating system that can execute multiple tasks at the same time. However,the question is:can a person really be a multitasker?

For most scientists,the answer is no.So much so that,according to experts in neuroscience (神经系统科学),

our brains do not handle multitasking situations well.As soon as two tasks require our attention,productivity suffers.What we call multitasking,therefore,is in reality the ability to move more or less quickly from one task to another.This requires two essential conditions:that one of the tasks needs to be automatic,like walking or eating,and that they both need different mental processes.Answering the phone and writing at the same time,for example.

However,on the other side of the coin there are people who maintain that it is possible to be,or at least seem to be,multitasking.A recent study concluded that regardless of whether people are actually handling several tasks or not,the mere fact that they perceive this activity as multitasking has a positive effect on their performance.

The business perspective offers a different view:multitasking is understood as the ability to adapt to all types of environment within a company and effectively undertake different activities within a set time frame. Indeed,many companies look for people who are skilled in multitasking to improve their productivity.From this different perspective,you can not only be multitasking but this ability can also be taught:something that is easier in fluid organisations,which favour flexibility in their working practices.

The benefits of multitasking are clear.Being quicker and more efficient increases our performance and the number of tasks completed.But having to pay attention to several things at once means that the powers of concentration are reduced and that can lead to more mistakes.

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51.What does a“multitasker”originally refer to?

A)An operating system capable of doing several tasks at once.

B)A skilled worker executing more than one task at the same time.

C)A sophisticated technology doing several tasks effectively at once.

D)An efficient person able to perform multiple tasks at the same time.

52.Why can't people really be multitaskers according to neuroscientists?

A)They are not sufficiently exposed to multitasking situations.

B)They are not comparable to mechanical operating systems.

C)Their brains do not allow them to multitask.

D)Their attention span cannot be expanded.

53.What do we learn from the conclusion of a recent study on multitasking?

A)People make greater achievements by maintaining whatever they are doing is multitasking.

B)People's performance benefits from the perception of what they are doing as multitasking.

C)People's active mental processes exert a positive effect on their multitasking.

D)People can improve their capabilities by handling multitasking situations.

54.How does the business world view multitasking?

A)It is a rare skill often found in fluid organisations.

B)It is an adaptable capability required of all workers.

C)It is an essential quality many employees lack.

D)It is a desirable ability that can be developed.

55.What does the author imply we should do if we have to focus on some task and do it well?

A)Work in a flexible way.

B)Learn from mistakes

C)Avoid multitasking.

D)Increase efficiency

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阅读答案：ACBDC

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随写区

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Text 5

In the history of horse racing, few horses have captured the affection of the British public like Red Rum.Today,three decades after his retirement,he is still one of the best-known and most beloved racehorses of all time.

Red Rum was passed around to several owners before being purchased for Noel Le Mar.The agent who made the purchase was the now-legendary horse trainer Donald “Ginger”McCain.

It wasn't apparent at the time,but Red Rum had a serious bone disease in his foot.For many horses (and many trainers)this would mean the end of a racing career before it even began.For Ginger and Red Rum,though,it was just an obstacle to greatness that had to be overcome.

Red Rum's true talent came out in steeplechases(障碍赛马).His power,speed and jumping ability carried him to his first Grand National title in 1973.The very next year, Red Rum returned to take his second title.He was the first horse to take successive firsts since Reynolds town in 1935-1936.Red Rum's spirit and grace had already begun to charm the leagues of Grand National fans.

In the following two years,Red Rum lost out on the title,coming in second both times. When he returned in 1977 to try again,he was largely regarded as past his prime.He was 12 years old and not expected to place highly.He surprised sporting fans around the world when he came in a remarkable 25 lengths ahead of the nearest horse,taking his third Grand National win.To this day,Red Rum's third win is known as one of the greatest moments in horse racing history

Red Rum was headed for the Grand National once again in 1978 but suffered an injury in one of his heels shortly before the race.He was retired soon after,but his public life and fame by no means decreased with the end of his career.Red Rum traveled all over the country for various engagements.He often led pre-race parades at Aintree Racecourse and was a popular guest at charity benefits and public events.

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46.What do we learn from the passage about Red Rum the racehorse?

A)He captured public affection long before he won national titles.

B)He won enormous fame and love from British people.

C)He became a myth three decades after his retirement.

D)He owed his great success to several well-known horse trainers.

47.What did the serious bone disease in Red Rum's foot mean to himself and his trainer?

A)It was simply a hindrance they had to get over to excel.

B)It was surely a disadvantage though not considered fatal.

C)It was actually the end of a racing career that had just begun.

D)It was really a major obstacle hard to overcome on their own.

48.What does the author say Red Rum did with his power,speed and jumping ability?

A)He won his first Grand National title at 12.

B)He took two firsts successively in 1935-1936.

C)He surprised sporting fans worldwide in 1973.

D)He took three Grand National wins in the 1970s.

49.What did people generally think of Red Rum when he returned to the racecourse in 1977?

A)He had already passed the peak of his racing life.

B)He would have no rival in Grand National steeplechases.

C)He had lost his charm with the leagues of Grand National fans.

D)He could be expected to repeat his glory in the prime of his career.

50.What became of Red Rum after his career ended?

A)He suffered from severe pain in a heel.

B)He spent almost all his time traveling.

C)He lived on various charity benefits.

D)He remained famous and popular.

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT6

People in business often make decisions based on their own personal feelings or instincts.It is quite horrifying to see people being guided by some unknown force.But how wise is it,really,to let your instincts drive your decisions?

In the decision-making process,relying on instincts only makes sense when you have a vast experience to support you.Simply "feeling"that something is right or should be done is highly subjective and can drown you.

On the other hand,there is a more rational approach to making decisions.Data and analysis have long been associated with informed decisions.These reduce the likelihood of errors and increase the chances of success.Big,systematic data is mostly the foundation of most of our decisions,personal and business alike.But with its extreme usability comes a complication:what do you do if you strongly feel something should not be done,even if the data insists that it should?

This seemingly easy question is what drives the need to understand the relationship between instincts and data in the decision-making process.Without making things complicated,the solution to this dilemma is using data and instincts in conjunction to arrive at the best possible decisions.

Instinctive decisions are always backed by previous experiences or information,which acknowledges that instinctive decisions have worked in the past.Decisions are not about making the choice and braving the consequences because you want to blindly trust your instincts.They are about combining your inner wisdom with the knowledge of systematic data to make the best decisions.

Sometimes,rational analysis and data are impractical to be employed in certain situations.Absence of definitive criteria,and time and resource constraints,and novel situations are instances which limit the practicality of data.The only

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feasible option is to rely on what your instincts tell you.In these situations,instincts can help you make effective and quick decisions.

Combining instinctive and rational analysis produces well-rounded decisions.It reduces the chances of making mistakes,and has increasingly become a favorite approach to decision-making among leaders of today.

51.What does the author say business people often do?

A)Strive to make sense of some unknown forces.
B)Avoid being driven by their own feelings.
C)Draw on a vast wealth of past experience.
D)Rely on instincts in decision-making.

52.What should we take into account in order to make informed decisions?
A)The likelihood of errors.
B)Systematic data and analysis.
C)The complexity of circumstances.
D)Personal feelings and business strategies.

53.What should people do in a decision-making process if instincts disagree with data?
A)Resolve the dilemma with previous experience.
B)Figure out which of the two is more reliable.
C)Combine the two together.
D)Prioritize instincts over data.

54.What should we do when facing various factors that limit the practicality of data?
A)Make a rational and systematic analysis.
B)Explore the most feasible options.
C)Resort to our inner wisdom.
D)Apply definitive criteria.

55.What does it take for decisions to become the best according to the author?
A)Applying instincts and data in conjunction.
B)Assessing all factors when making a choice.
C)Recalling what has actually worked in the past.
D)Refraining from trusting instincts arbitrarily.

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随写区

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TEXT7

When is cleaning walls a crime? When you're doing it to create art, obviously. A number of street artists around the world have started expressing themselves through a practice known as reverse graffiti (涂鸦). They find dirty surfaces and paint them with images or messages using cleaning brushes or pressure hoses (高压水管). Either way, it's the same principle: the image is made by cleaning away the dirt. Each artist has their own individual style but all artists share a common aim: to draw attention to the pollution in our cities. The UK's Paul Curtis, better known as Moose, operates around Leeds and London and has been commissioned by a number of companies to make reverse graffiti advertisements.

Brazilian artist, Alexandra Orion, turned one of Sao Paulo's transport tunnels into an amazing wall painting in 2006 by getting rid of the dirt. Made up of a series of white skulls (颅骨), the painting reminds drivers of the effect their pollution is having on the planet. "Every motorist sits in the comfort of their car, but they don't give any consideration to the price their comfort has for the environment and consequently for themselves," says Orion.

The anti-pollution message of the reverse graffiti artists confuses city authorities since the main argument against graffiti is that it spoils the appearance of both types of property: public and private. This was what Leeds City Council said about Moose's work: "Leeds residents want to live in clean and attractive neighbour hoods. We view this kind of advertising as environmental damage and will take strong action against it." Moose was ordered to "clean up his act." How was he supposed to do this: by making all property he had cleaned dirty again?

As for the Brazilian artist's work, the authorities were annoyed but could find nothing to charge him with. They had no other option but to clean the tunnel—but only the parts Alexandra had already cleaned. The artist merely continued his campaign on the other side. The city officials then decided to take drastic action. They not only cleaned the whole tunnel but every tunnel in Sao Paulo.

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46.What do we learn from the passage about reverse graffiti?
A)It uses paint to create anti-pollution images.
B)It causes lots of distraction to drivers.
C)It creates a lot of trouble for local residents.
D)It turns dirty walls into artistic works.

47. What do reverse graffiti artists try to do?
A) Publicise their artistic pursuit.
B) Beautify the city environment.
C) Raise public awareness of environmental pollution.
D) Express their dissatisfaction with local governments.

48. What do we learn about Brazilian artist Alexandre Orion?
A) He was good at painting white skulls.
C) He suggested banning all polluting cars.
B) He chose tunnels to do his graffiti art.
D) He was fond of doing creative artworks.

49. What does the author imply about Leeds City Council's decision?
A) It is simply absurd.
C) It is rather unexpected
B) It is well-informed.
D) It is quite sensible.

50. How did Sao Paulo city officials handle Alexandre Orion's reverse graffiti?
A) They made him clean all the tunnels in Sao Paulo.
B) They took drastic action to ban all reverse graffiti.
C) They charged him with polluting tunnels in the city.
D) They made it impossible for him to practice his art.

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随写区

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TEXT8

Three children in every classroom have a diagnosable mental health condition. Half of these are behavioural disorders, while one third are emotional disorders such as stress, anxiety and depression, which often become outwardly apparent through self-harm. There was an astonishing 52 per cent jump in hospital admissions for children and young people who had harmed themselves between 2009 and 2015.

Schools and teachers have consistently reported the scale of the problem since 2009. Last year, over half of teachers reported that more of their pupils experience mental health problems than in the past. But teachers also consistently report how ill-equipped they feel to meet pupils' mental health needs, and often cite a lack of training, expertise and support from the National Health Service (英国国宋医疗服务体系).

Part of the reason for the increased pressure on schools is that there are now fewer 'early intervention (干预)' and low-level mental health services based in the community. Cuts to local authority budgets since 2010 have resulted in a significant decline of these services, despite strong evidence of their effectiveness in preventing crises further down the line.

The only way to break the pressures on both mental health services and schools is to reinvest in early intervention services inside schools.

There are strong arguments for why schools are best placed to provide mental health services. Schools see young people more than any other service, which gives them a unique ability to get to hard-to-reach children and young people and build meaningful relationships with them over time. Recent studies have shown that children and young people largely prefer to see a counsellor in school rather than in an outside environment. Young people have reported that for low-level conditions such as stress and anxiety, a clinical setting can sometimes be daunting（令人却步的）.

There are already examples of innovative schools which combine mental health and wellbeing provision with a strong academic curriculum. This will, though, require a huge cultural shift. Politicians, policymakers, commissioners and school leaders must be brave enough to make the leap towards reimagining schools as providers of health as well as education services.

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46What are teachers complaining about?
A)There are too many students requiring special attention.
B)They are under too much stress counselling needy students.
C)Schools are inadequately equipped to implement any intervention.
D)They lack the necessary resources to address pupils' mental problems.

47.What do we learn from the passage about community health services in Britain?
A)They have deteriorated due to budget cuts.
B)They facilitate local residents' everyday lives.
C)They prove ineffective in helping mental patients.
D)They cover preventative care for the local residents.

48.Where does the author suggest mental health services be placed?
A) At home.
B) At school.
C) In hospitals.
D) In communities.

49. What do we learn from the recent studies?
A) Students prefer to rely on peers to relieve stress and anxiety.
B) Young people are keen on building meaningful relationships.
C) Students are more comfortable seeking counselling in school.
D) Young people benefit from various kinds of outdoor activities.

50. What does the author mean by a cultural shift (Line 2, Para. 6)?
A) Simplification of schools' academic curriculums.
B) Parents' involvement in schools' policy-making.
C) A change in teachers' attitudes to mental health.
D) A change in the conception of what schools are.

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阅读答案：DABCD

词汇拓展：请将文中生词整理誊写至下面区域

生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT9

Picture this: You're at a movie theater food stand loading up on snacks. You have a choice of a small, medium or large soda. The small is $3.50 and the large is $5.50. It's a tough decision: The small size may not last you through the whole movie, but $5.50 for some sugary drink seems ridiculous. But there's a third option, a medium soda for $5.25. Medium may be the perfect amount of soda for you, but the large is only a quarter more. If you're like most people, you end up buying the large (and taking a bathroom break midshow).

If you're wondering who would buy the medium soda, the answer is almost no one. In fact, there's a good chance the marketing department purposely priced the medium soda as a decoy (诱), making you more likely to buy the large soda rather than the small.

I have written about this peculiarity in human nature before with my friend Dan Ariely, who studied this phenomenon extensively after noticing pricing for subscriptions (订阅) to The Economist. The digital subscription was $59, the print subscription was $125, and the print plus digital subscription was also $125. No one in their right mind would buy the print subscription when you could get digital as well for the same price, so why was it even an option? Ariely ran an experiment and found that when only the two "real" choices were offered, more people chose the less-expensive digital subscription. But the addition of the bad option made people much more likely to choose the more expensive print plus digital option.

Brain scientists call this effect "asymmetric dominance" and it means that people gravitate toward the choice nearest a clearly inferior option. Marketing professors call it the decoy effect, which is certainly easier to remember. Lucky for consumers, almost no one in the business community understands it.

The decoy effect works because of the way our brains assign value when making choices. Value is almost never absolute; rather, we decide an object's value relative to our other choices. If more options are introduced, the value equation changes.

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51.Why does the author ask us to imagine buying food in the movie theater?
A)To illustrate people's peculiar shopping behavior.
B)To illustrate the increasing variety of snacks there
C) To show how hard it can be to choose a drink there.
D)To show how popular snacks are among movie fans.

52.Why is the medium soda priced the way it is?
A)To attract more customers to buy it.
B)To show the price matches the amount.
C)To ensure customers drink the right amount of soda.
D)To make customers believe they are getting a bargain.

53.What do we learn from Dan Ariely's experiment?
A)Lower-priced goods attract more customers.
B)The Economist's promotional strategy works.
C)The Economist's print edition turns out to sell the best.
D)More readers choose the digital over the print edition.

54.For what purpose is "the bad option" (Line 7, Para. 3) added?
A)To cater to the peculiar needs of some customers.
B)To help customers to make more rational choices.
C)To trap customers into buying the more pricey item.
D)To provide customers with a greater variety of goods.

55.How do we assess the value of a commodity, according to the passage?
A)By considering its usefulness.
B)By taking its quality into account.
C)By comparing it with other choices.
D) By examining its value equation.

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阅读答案：ADBCB

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT10

Boredom has, paradoxically, become quite interesting to academics lately. In early May, London's Boring Conference celebrated seven years of delighting in dullness. At this event, people flocked to talks about weather, traffic jams, and vending-machine sounds, among other sleep-inducing topics.

What, exactly, is everybody studying? One widely accepted psychological definition of boredom is "the distasteful experience of wanting, but being unable, to engage in satisfying activity." But how can you quantify a person's boredom level and compare it with someone else's? In 1986, psychologists introduced the Boredom Proneness Scale, designed to measure an individual's overall tendency to feel bored. By contrast, the Multidimensional State Boredom Scale, developed in 2008, measures a person's feelings of boredom in a given situation.

Boredom has been linked to behavior issues including inattentive driving, mindless snacking, excessive drinking, and addictive gambling. In fact, many of us would choose pain over boredom. One team of psychologists discovered that two-thirds of men and a quarter of women would rather self-administer electric shocks than sit alone with their thoughts for 15 minutes. Researching this phenomenon, another team asked volunteers to watch boring, sad, or neutral films, during which they could self-administer electric shocks. The bored volunteers shocked themselves more and harder than the sad or neutral ones did.

But boredom isn't all bad. By encouraging self-reflection and daydreaming, it can spur creativity. An early study gave participants abundant time to complete problem-solving and word-association exercises.Once all the obvious answers were exhausted, participants gave more and more inventive answers to combat boredom. A British study took these findings one step further, asking subjects to complete a creative challenge (coming up with a list of alternative uses for a household item). One group of subjects did a boring activity first, while the others went straight to the creative task. Those whose boredom pumps had been primed were more productive.

In our always-connected world, boredom may be a hard-to-define state, but it is a fertile one. Watch paint dry or water boil, or at least put away your smartphone for a while, and you might unlock your next big idea.

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46.When are people likely to experience boredom, according to an accepted psychological definition?
A)When they don't have the chance to do what they want.
B)When they don't enjoy the materials they are studying.
C)When they experience something unpleasant.
D)When they engage in some routine activities.

47.What does the author say boredom can lead to?
A)Determination.
B) Concentration.
C) Mental deterioration.
D) Harmful conduct.

48. What is the finding of one team of psychologists in their experiment?
A) Volunteers prefer watching a boring movie to sitting alone deliberating.
B) Many volunteers choose to hurt themselves rather than endure boredom.
C) Male volunteers are more immune to the effects of boredom than females.
D) Many volunteers are unable to resist boredom longer than fifteen minutes.

49. Why does the author say boredom isn't all bad?
A) It stimulates memorization.
C) It may promote creative thinking.
B) It allows time for relaxation.
D) It may facilitate independent learning.

50. What does the author suggest one do when faced with a challenging problem?
A) Stop idling and think big.
B) Unlock one's smartphone.
C) Look around oneself for stimulation.
D) Allow oneself some time to be bored.

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随写区

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TEXT11

Forests in countries like Brazil and the Congo get a lot of attention from environmentalists, and it is easy to see why. South America and sub-Saharan Africa are experiencing deforestation on an enormous scale: every year almost 5 million hectares are lost. But forests are also changing in rich Western countries. They are growing larger, both in the sense that they occupy more land and that the trees in them are bigger. What is going on?

Forests are spreading in almost all Western countries, with the fastest growth in places that historically had rather few trees. In 1990 28% of Spain was forested; now the proportion is 37%. In both Greece and Italy, the growth was from 26% to 32% over the same period. Forests are gradually taking more land in America and Australia. Perhaps most astonishing is the trend in Ireland. Roughly 1% of that country was forested when it became independent in 1922. Now forests cover 11% of the land, and the government wants to push the proportion to 18% by the 2040s.

Two things are fertilising this growth. The first is the abandonment of farmland, especially in high, dry places where nothing grows terribly well. When farmers give up trying to earn a living from farming or herding, trees simply move in: The second is government policy and subsidy. Throughout history,governments have protected and promoted forests for diverse reasons, ranging from the need for wooden warships to a desire to promote suburban house-building. Nowadays forests are increasingly welcome because they suck in carbon pollution from the air. The justifications change; the desire for more trees remains constant.

The greening of the West does not delight everyone. Farmers complain that land is being taken out of use by generously subsidised tree plantations. Parts of Spain and Portugal suffer from terrible forest fires. Others simply dislike the appearance of forests planted in neat rows. They will have to get used to the trees, however. The growth of Western forests seems almost as unstoppable as deforestation elsewhere.

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51.What is catching environmentalists' attention nowadays?
A)Rich countries are stripping poor ones of their resources.
B)Forests are fast shrinking in many developing countries.
C)Forests are eating away the fertile farmland worldwide.
D)Rich countries are doing little to address deforestation.

52.Which countries have the fastest forest growth?
A)Those that have newly achieved independence.
B)Those that have the greatest demand for timber.
C) Those that used to have the lowest forest coverage.
D) Those that provide enormous government subsidies

53. What has encouraged forest growth historically?
A) The government's advocacy.
B) The use of wood for fuel.
C) The favourable climate.
D) The green movement.

54. What accounts for our increasing desire for forests?
A) Their unique scenic beauty.
B) Their use as fruit plantations.
C) Their capability of improving air quality.
D) Their stable supply of building materials.

55. What does the author conclude about the prospects of forestation?
A) Deserts in sub-Saharan Africa will diminish gradually.
B) It will play a more and more important role in people's lives.
C) Forest destruction in the developing world will quickly slow down.
D) Developed and developing countries are moving in opposite directions.

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阅读答案：BCACD

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT12

A growing number of U.S. bike riders are attracted to electric bikes for convenience, health benefits and their fun factor. Although ebikes first appeared in the 90s, cheaper options and longer-lasting batteries are breathing new life into the concept.

Established bike companies and startups are embracing ebikes to meet demand. About 34 million e bikes were sold worldwide last year, according to data from ecycle Electric Consultants. Most were sold in Europe and China, where the bikes already have exploded in popularity. Recently, the U. S. market has grown to 263,000 bikes, a 25% gain from the prior year.

The industry is benefiting from improved batteries as suppliers over the years developed technology for laptops, smartphones and electric cars. In 2004, the price of batteries used on ebikes fell, spurring European sales.

But lower cost options are emerging, too. This month, three U.S. bike share companies, Motivate, Lime Bike and Spin, announced electric bicycles will be added to their fleets. New York-based Jump Bikes is already operating an electric bike share in Washington, D. C., and is launching in San Francisco Thursday. Rides cost $2 for 30 minutes.

The system works like existing dock less bike share systems, where riders unlock bikes through a smartphone app. "This is the beginning of a long-term shift away from regular pedal (z 板) to electric bikes," said Jump Bikes CEO Ryan Rzepecki. "When people first jump on an ebike, their face lights up.It's exciting and joyful in a way that you don't get from a regular bike."

Two years ago, CEO Chris Cocalis of Pivot Cycles, which sells high-end mountain bikes, found that U.S. bike shops weren't interested in stocking ebikes. Some retailers warned Cocalis that they'd drop the brand if it came out with an electric bike.

Now that sales are taking off, the vast majority of bike dealers are asking Cocalis when he'll make an ebike available. "There's tremendous opportunity to get a generation of people for whom suffering isn't their thing," Cocalis said. "Ebike riders get the enjoyable part of cycling without the massive suffering of climbing huge hills."

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46.What do we learn from the passage about ebikes?
A)Their health benefits and fun values outweigh their cost.
B)They did not catch public attention in the United States until the 1990s.
C)They did not become popular until the emergence of improved batteries.
D)Their widespread use is attributable to people's environmental awareness.

47.What brought about the boost in ebike sales in Europe at the beginning of the century?
A)Updated technology of bike manufacture.
B) The falling prices of ebike batteries.
C)Changed fashion in short-distance travel.
D)The rising costs for making electric cars.

48.What is the prospect of the bike industry according to Ryan Rzepecki?
A)More will be invested in bike battery research.
B)The sales of ebikes will increase.
C) It will profit from ebike sharing.
D) It will make a difference in people's daily lives.

49. What prevented Chris Cocalis from developing ebikes sooner?
A) Retailers' refusal to deal in ebikes.
B) High profits from conventional bikes.
C) Users' concern about risks of ebike riding.
D) His focus on selling costly mountain bikes.

50. What makes Chris Cocalis believe there is a greater opportunity for ebike sales?
A) The further lowering of ebike prices.
B) The public's concern for their health.
C) The increasing interest in mountain climbing.
D) The younger generation's pursuit of comfortable riding.

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随写区

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TEXT13

The terms "global warming" and "climate change" are used by many, seemingly interchangeably. But do they really mean the same thing?

Scientists shaped the history of the terms while attempting to accurately describe how humans continue to alter the planet. Later, political strategists adopted the terms to influence public opinion.In 1975, geochemist Wallace Broecker introduced the term "climate change" in an article published by Science.

In 1979, a National Academy of Sciences report used the term "global warming" to define increases in the Earth's average surface temperature, while "climate change" more broadly referred to the numerous effects of this increase, such as sea-level rise and ocean acidification (酸化).

During the following decades, some industrialists and politicians launched a campaign to sow doubt in the minds of the American public about the ability of fossil-fuel use, deforestation and other human activities to influence the planet's climate.

Word use played a critical role in developing that doubt. For example, the language and polls expert Frank Luntz wrote a memo encouraging the use of "climate change" because the phrase sounded less scary than "global warming," reported the Guardian.

However, Luntz's recommendation wasn't necessary. A Google Ngram Viewer chart shows that by 1993 climate change was already more commonly used in books than global warming. By the end of the next decade both words were used more frequently, and climate change was used nearly twice as often as global warming.

NASA used the term "climate change" because it more accurately reflects the wide range of changes to the planet caused by increasing amounts of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere.The debate isn't new. A century ago, chemist Svante Arrhenius started one of the first debates over the potential for humans to influence the planet's climate. Arrhenius calculated the capability of carbon dioxide to trap heat in the Earth's atmosphere, but other chemists disagreed. Some argued that humans weren't producing enough greenhouse gases, while others claimed the effects would be tiny. Now, of course, we know that whatever you call it, human behavior is warming the planet, with grave consequences ahead.

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51.Why did politicians use the two terms "global warming" and "climate change"?
A)To sway public opinion of the impact of human activities on Earth.
B)To more accurately describe the consequences of human activities.
C)To win more popular votes in their campaign activities.
D)To assure the public of the safety of existing industries

52.As used in a National Academy of Sciences report, the term "climate change" differs from "global warming" in that
A)it sounds less vague
B) it looks more scientific
C) it covers more phenomena
D) it is much closer to reality

53. What did industrialists of the late 20th century resort to in order to mislead Americans?
A) Made-up survey results.
B) Hired climate experts.
C) False research findings
D) Deliberate choice of words.

54. Why did NASA choose the term "climate change"?
A) To obtain more funds
B) For greater precision.
C) For political needs.
D) To avoid debate.

55. What is the author's final conclusion?
A) Global warming is the more accurate term.
B) Accuracy of terminology matters in science.
C) Human activities have serious effects on Earth.
D) Politics interferes with serious scientific debate.

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阅读答案：ACDBC

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT14

Educators and business leaders have more in common than it may seem. Teachers want to prepare students for a successful future. Technology companies have an interest in developing a workforce with the STEM (science, technology, engineering and math) skills needed to grow the company and advance the industry. How can they work together to achieve these goals? Play may be the answer.

Focusing on STEM skills is important, but the reality is that STEM skills are enhanced and more relevant when combined with traditional, hands-on creative activities. This combination is proving to be the best way to prepare today's children to be the makers and builders of tomorrow. That is why technology companies are partnering with educators to bring back good, old-fashioned play.In fact many experts argue that the most important 21st-century skills aren't related to specific technologies or subject matter, but to creativity; skills like imagination, problem-finding and problem-solving, teamwork, optimism, patience and the ability to experiment and take risks. These are skills acquired when kids tinker-(鼓捣小玩意): High-tech industries such as NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory have found that their best overall problem solvers were master tinkerers in their youth.

There are cognitive (认 知 的) benefits of doing things the way we did as children-building something, tearing it down, then building it up again. Research shows that given 15 minutes of free play, four- and five-year-olds will spend a third of this time engaged in spatial, mathematical, and architectural activities. This type of play-especially with building blocks-helps children discover and develop key principles in math and geometry.

If play and building are critical to 21st-century skill development, that's really good news for two reasons: Children are born builders, makers, and creators, so fostering (培养) 21st-century skills may be as simple as giving kids room to play, tinker and try things out, even as they grow older. Secondly, it doesn't take 21st-century technology to foster 21st-century skills. This is especially important for underresourced schools and communities. Taking whatever materials are handy and tinkering with them is a simple way to engage those important "maker" skills. And anyone, anywhere, can do it.

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46.What does the author say about educators?
A)They seek advice from technology companies to achieve teaching goals.
B)They have been successful in preparing the workforce for companies.
C)They help students acquire the skills needed for their future success.
D)They partner with technology companies to enhance teaching efficiency.

47.How can educators better develop students' STEM skills, according to the author?
A)By blending them with traditional, stimulating activities
B) By inviting business leaders to help design curriculums.
C) By enhancing students' ability to think in a critical way.
D) By showing students the best way to learn is through play.

48.How do children acquire the skills needed for the 21st century?
A)By engaging in activities involving specific technologies.
B)By playing with things to solve problems on their own.
C)By familiarizing themselves with high-tech gadgets.
D)By mastering basic principles through teamwork.

49.What can we do to help children learn the basics of math and geometry?
A)Stimulate their interest as early as possible.
B) Spend more time playing games with them.
C) Encourage them to make things with hands.
D) Allow them to tinker freely with calculators.

50. What does the author advise disadvantaged schools and communities to do?
Train students to be makers to meet future market demands.
Develop students' creative skills with the resources available.
C) Engage students with challenging tasks to foster their creativity.
D) Work together with companies to improve their teaching facilities.

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阅读答案：CABCB

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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TEXT15

Being an information technology, or IT, worker is not a job I envy. They are the ones who, right in the middle of a critical meeting, are expected to instantly fix the projector that's no longer working. They have to tolerate the bad tempers of colleagues frustrated at the number of times they've had to call the help desk for the same issue. They are also the ones who know there are systems that are more powerful, reliable and faster, but their employer simply will not put up the funds to buy them.

According to a recent survey, employees who have a job reliant on IT support consider IT a major source of job dissatisfaction. Through no fault of their own, they can suddenly find their productivity deteriorating or quality control non-existent. And there's little they can do about it.

The experience of using IT penetrates almost the entire work field. It has become a crucial part of employees' overall work experience. When IT is operating as it should, employee self-confidence swells.Their job satisfaction, too, can surge when well-functioning machines relieve them of dull tasks or repetitive processes. But if there's one thing that triggers widespread employee frustration, it's an IT transformation project gone wrong, where swollen expectations have been popped and a long list of promised efficiencies have been reversed. This occurs when business leaders implement IT initiatives with little consideration of how those changes will impact the end user.

Which is why managers should appreciate just how influential the IT user experience is to their employees, and exert substantial effort in ensuring their IT team eliminates programming errors and application crashes. Adequate and timely IT support should also be available to enable users to cope with technological issues at work. More importantly, IT practitioners need to understand what employees experience mentally when they use IT.

Therefore, businesses need to set up their IT infrastructure so that it is designed to fit in with their employees' work, rather than adjust their work to fit in with the company's IT limitations.

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51.What does the author say about working in IT?
A) It is envied by many.
B) It does not appeal to him.
C) It is financially rewarding.
D) It does not match his abilities.

52. What is the finding of a recent survey on employees who have a job reliant on IT support?
A) IT helps boost productivity.
B) IT helps improve quality control.
C) Many employees are deeply frustrated by IT.
D) Most employees rely heavily on ITin their work.

53. What is said to happen when IT is functioning properly?
A) There is a big boost in employees' work efficiency.
B) Employees become more dependent on machines.
C) There are no longer any boring or repetitive tasks.
D) Employees become more confident in their work.

54. What should business leaders do before implementing new IT initiatives?
A) Consider the various expectations of their customers.
B) Draw up a list of the efficiencies to be promised.
C) Assess the swollen cost of training the employees.
D) Think about the possible effects on their employees.

55. How can a business help improve its employees' experience in using IT?
A) By designing systems that suit their needs.
B) By ensuring that their mental health is sound.
C) By adjusting their work to suit the IT system.
D) By offering them regular in-service training.

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随写区

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TEXT16

Sugar shocked. That describes the reaction of many Americans this week following revelations that, 50 years ago, the sugar industry paid Harvard scientists for research that shifted the focus away from sugar's role in heart disease-and put the spotlight (注意的中心) squarely on dietary fat.

What might surprise consumers is just how many present-day nutrition studies are still funded by the food industry. Nutrition scholar Marion Nestle of New York University spent a year informally tracking industry-funded studies on food. "Roughly 90% of nearly 170 studies favored the sponsor's interest," Nestle tells us. Other systematic reviews support her conclusions.

For instance, studies funded by Welch Foods-the brand behind Welch's 100% Grape Juice-found that drinking Concord grape juice daily may boost brain function. Another, funded by Quaker Oats, concluded, as a Daily Mail story put it, that "hot oatmeal (燕麦粥) breakfast keeps you full for longer."

Last year, The New York Times revealed how Coca-Cola was funding well-known scientists and organizations promoting a message that, in the battle against weight gain, people should pay more attention to exercise and less to what they eat and drink. Coca-Cola also released data detailing its funding of several medical institutions and associations between 2010 and 2015.

"It's certainly a problem that so much research in nutrition and health is funded by industry," says Bonnie Liebman, director of nutrition at the Center for Science in the Public Interest. "When the food industry pays for research, it often gets what it pays for." And what it pays for is often a pro-industry finding.

Given thisenv ironment, consumers should_be-skeptical (怀疑的)when reading the latest finding-in -nutrition science and ignore the latest study that pops up on your news feed. "Rely on health experts who've reviewed all the evidence," Liebman says, pointing to the official government Dietary Guidelines,which are based on reviews of hundreds of studies.

"And that expert advice remains pretty simple," says Nestle. "We know what healthy diets are-lots of vegetables, not too much junk food, balanced calories. Everything else is really difficult to do experimentally."

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46.46.What did Harvard scientists do 50 years ago?

A) They raised public awareness of the possible causes of heart disease.

B) They turned public attention away from the health risks of sugar to fat.

C) They placed the sugar industry in the spotlight with their new findings.

D) They conducted large-scale research on the role of sugar in people's health.

47.What does Marion Nestle say about present-day nutrition studies?

A) They took her a full year to track and analyze.

B) Most of them are based on systematic reviews.

C) They depend on funding from the food industries.

D) Nearly all of them serve the purpose of the funders.

48.What did Coca-Cola-funded studies claim?

A) Exercise is more important to good health than diet.

B) Choosing what to eat and drink is key to weight control.

C) Drinking Coca-Cola does not contribute to weight gain.

D) The food industry plays a major role in fighting obesity.

49.What does Liebman say about industry-funded research?

A) It simply focuses on nutrition and health.

B) It causes confusion among consumers.

C) It rarely results in objective findings.

D) It runs counter to the public interest.

50.What is the author's advice to consumers?

A) Follow their intuition in deciding what to eat.

B) Be doubtful of diet experts' recommendations.

C) Ignore irrelevant information on their news feed.

D) Think twice about new nutrition research findings.

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生词	文中搭配	中文释义

随写区

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长篇阅读方法

From Accountant to Yogi: Making a Radical Career Change

[A] At some point, almost all of us will experience a period of radical professional change. Some of us will seek it out; for others it will feel like an unwelcome intrusion into otherwise stable careers. Either way, we have choices about how we respond to it when it comes.

[B] We recently caught up with yoga entrepreneur Leah Zaccaria, who put herself through the fire of change to completely reinvent herself. In her search to live a life of purpose, Leah left her high-paying accounting job, her husband, and her home, hi the process, she built a radically new life and career. Since then, she has founded two yoga studios, met a new life partner, and formed a new community of people. Even if your personal reinvention is less drastic, we think there are lessons from her experience that apply.

[C] Where do the seeds of change come from? the Native American Indians have a saying: “Pay attention to the whispers so you won’t have to hear the screams.” Often the best ideas for big changes come from unexpected places — it’s just a matter of tuning in. Great leaders recognize the weak signals or slight signs that point to big changes to come. Leah reflects on a time she listened to the whispers: “About the time my daughter was five years old. I started having a sense that ‘this isn’t right.”’ She then realized that her life no longer matched her vision for it.

[D] Up until that point, Leah had followed traditional measures of success. After graduating with a degree in business and accounting, she joined a public accounting firm, married, bought a house, put lots of stuff in it, and had a baby. “I did what everybody else thought looked successful,” she says. Leah easily could have fallen into a trap of feeling content; instead, her energy sparked a period of experimentation and renewal.

[E] Feeling the need to change, Leah started playing with future possibilities by exploring her interests and developing new capabilities. First trying physical exercise and dieting, she lost some weight and discovered an inner strength. “1 felt powerful because 1 broke through my own limitations,” she recalls.

[F] However, it was another interest that led Leah to radically reinvent herself. “I remember sitting on a bench with my aunt at a yoga studio,’’ she said, having a moment of clarity right then and there: Yoga is saving my life. Yoga is waking me up. I’m not happy and I want to change and I’m done with this.” In that

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moment of clarity Leah made an important leap,conquering her inner resistance to change and making a firm commitment to take bigger steps.

[G] Creating the future you want is a lot easier if you are ready to exploit the opportunities that come your way. When Leah made the commitment to change, she primed herself to new opportunities she may otherwise have overlooked. She recalls:

[H] One day a man I worked with, Ryan, who had his office next to mine, said, “Leah, let’s go look at this space on Queen Anne.” He knew my love for yoga and had seen a space close to where he lived that he thought might be good to serve as a yoga studio. As soon as I saw the location, I knew this was it. Of course I was scared, yet I had this strong sense of “I have to do this.” Only a few months later Leah opened her first yoga studio, but success was not instant.

[I] Creating the future takes time. That’s why leaders continue to manage the present while building toward the big changes of the future. When it’s time to make the leap, they take action and immediately drop what’s no longer serving their purpose. Initially Leah stayed with her accounting job while starting up the yoga studio to make it all work.

[J] Soon after, she knew she had to make a bold move to fully commit to her new future. Within two years, Leah shed the safety of her accounting job and made the switch complete. Such drastic change is not easy.

[K] Steering through change and facing obstacles brings us face to face with our fears. Leah reflects on one incident that triggered her fears, when her investors threatened to shut her down: “I was probably up against the most fear I’ve ever had，” she says. “I had spent two years cultivating this community, and it had become successful very fast, but within six months I was facing the prospect of losing it all.”

[L] She connected with her sense of purpose and dug deep, cultivating a tremendous sense of strength. “I was feeling so intentional and strong that I wasn’t going to let fear just take over. I was thinking, ‘OK, guys, if you want to try to shut me down, shut me down.’And I knew it was a negotiation scheme, so I was

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able to say to myself, 'This is not real.'" By naming her fears and facing them head-on, Leah gained confidence. For most of us, letting go of the safety and security of the past gives us great fear. Calling out our fears explicitly, as Leah did,can help us act decisively.

[M] The cycle of renewal never ends. Leah's growth spurred her to open her second studio— and it wasn't for the money.

[N] I have no desire to make millions of dollars. It's not about that; it's about growth for me. Honestly, I didn't need to open a second studio. I was making as much money as I was as an accountant. But I know if you don't grow, you stand still, and that doesn't work for me.

[O] Consider the current moment in your own life, your team or your organization. Where are you in the cycle of renewal: Are you actively preserving the present, or selectively forgetting the past, or boldly creating the future? What advice would Leah give you to move you ahead on your journey? Once we're on the path of growth, we can continually move through the seasons of transformation and renewal.

36. Readiness to take advantage of new opportunities will make it easier to create one's desired future.
37. By conventional standards, Leah was a typical successful woman before she changed her career.
38. Leah gained confidence by laying out her fears and confronting them directly.
39. In search of a meaningful life, Leah gave up what she had and set up her own yoga studios.
40 Leah's interest in yoga prompted her to make a firm decision to reshape her life.
41. Small signs may indicate great changes to come and therefore merit attention.
42. Leah's first yoga studio was by no means an immediate success.
43. Some people regard professional change as an unpleasant experience that disturbs their stable careers.
44. The worst fear Leah ever had was the prospect of losing her yoga business.
45. As she explored new interests and developed new potentials，Leah felt powerful internally.

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长篇阅读答案：G D L B F C H A K E

TEXT2

How to determine if a company is a good fit for you

A)On paper, the job seemed perfect for me: The position was completely in line with my degree, the duties and responsibilities were compatible with my interests, and the office maintained a well-stocked kitchen that would satisfy my every snack desire.

B) Sounds like my dream job, right? There was only one small problem: I simply didn't get along with the company culture.They favored a more rigid, closed-door, corporate atmosphere, while I would have preferred something more collaborative and open. They were complete clock watchers, while I would have liked a more flexible schedule. To put it plainly, we just weren't on the same page.

C)When it comes to looking for a new job,you already know that a big part of the interview process involves the company evaluating whether or not you're a good fit for their open role. But, it's important to keep in mind that the employer isn't the only one who needs to identify a good match—you should be looking for that same exact thing. Company culture can have a big impact on how you feel about your work, so you want to make sure you sign an offer letter with an organization you're truly excited about.

D) However, figuring out what a company is like before you actually work there can be a bit of a challenge. Luckily, there are a few things you can do to determine whether or not a company is a good fit for you—before you ever sign your name on that dotted line.

E)First of all, know what you want.It's hard to make any decisions when you don't really know what you're looking for.So before you can determine whether you and a specific company would be compatible together, it's important to have a solid handle on what exactly you want from your employer. Many of us have an easier time identifying the things that we absolutely don't want. If those are the only things you can think of, don't worry! That's still a good place to start.

F)Start by writing down the things you didn't like about previous employers, as well as the parts you really valued. There's no wrong answer here—so from big things to small details, write them all down on your list. This will help you immediately identify what you're looking for in an organization, as well as the things you're trying to stay far, far away from.

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G)Make sure to do your research.Now comes the part when you put on your detective hat and do a little digging. The Internet will be your best friend when you're trying to familiarize yourself with a company's culture before ever walking through their office doors.And where exactly should you look for these culture clues? Start with the most obvious place first: the company's website.Read through their copy and blog. Do they use formal, direct language? Or is it casual, conversational, and maybe even a little humorous? This can be a big indicator of what sort of atmosphere the company is trying to cultivate.

H) Next, turn your attention toward their social media outlets.Are they sharing photos of their team's Thursday afternoon barbecue or Halloween costume contest? Or are their social media accounts strictly reserved for company-related announcements and product launches?

I) An industry review website like Glassdoor is another spot to check in order to find some insider information about what you can expect about a company. However, remember to take the reviews you read with a grain of salt-many of them are written by scorned(被鄙视的)employees .

J) Finally, you can never fail with personal connections. Send a quick message to a current or previous company employee on Linked In or by email and ask if they would be willing to have a quick conversation with you about the organization in general. If you get a yes to your request for a chat, you'll be armed with some pretty powerful and helpful information heading into your interview!

K) Learn more by asking questions. You know that part at the end of a job interview when the hiring manager asks if you have any questions, and you just stare across the table blankly with your mouth hanging open? That's the perfect opportunity to speak up and get your burning company culture questions answered! So yes, you can definitely ask your interviewer about what it's like to work for that particular organization. Simple questions like,“What three words would you use to describe the culture here?”or“What's your favorite part about working for this company?”can reveal a lot about what it's really like behind closed doors.

L)Prioritize your values.What does my dream company culture look like? Well, I could come and go as I please, as long as I was getting the work done. My boss would genuinely listen to and value all of my

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ideas arid suggestions. My co-workers would all be friendly with one another, without ever falling into the office gossip trap. The kitchen would have endless options of pizza and cookies. Oh, and they'd give me two months of paid vacation with a very generous salary.

M)What are my chances of finding all of those things with one employer? Slim to none — believe me, I've looked. This is why it's so important to know which aspects of a company's culture you value most.Is it an open communication style or a flexible schedule? Focus on the top spots on your priority list, and ensure a potential employer at least checks those boxes. Unfortunately, this is reality, you can't have everything you want but a few are certainly achievable.

N) When you're hunting for a new job, you already know that the employer is trying to decide whether or not you're a good fit for the position.But you should also look at the process through a similar lens. You may not be the one conducting the actual interview, but you're still trying to determine whether or not the company is a good fit for you.

O) Keep these tips in mind to figure out whether you and a potential employer are a perfect match or just a recipe(方案)for disaster.After all, it's a good thing to know before actually accepting an offer.

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36.Clues about the culture of a company can be found on its website.

37.It can be difficult to know the real situation in a company until you become part of it.

38.It is impossible for a job applicant to have every expectation met.

39.Simply by reading its description, the author found the job offered ideal.

40.Job applicants are advised to make a written list of their likes and dislikes in their previous employment.

41.At the end of an interview, a job applicant should seize the opportunity to get answers to their urgent questions.

42.To begin with, job applicants should be clear what they expect from their future employer.

43. Job applicants should read with a critical eye what is written about a company on the website.

44. Job satisfaction has a lot to do with company culture.

45.A chat with an insider of a company can give job applicants very useful information when they prepare for an interview.

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第二篇 阅读答案： G D M A F K E I C J

第三篇 There's a stress gap between men and women

A) "I used to work very hard. I love to create things, grow them and solve problems," said Meng Li, a successful app developer in San Francisco. "I didn't really care about my mind and my body until they decided to go on strike."

B) Ms. Li said her stress led to sleeplessness. When she did sleep, she experienced "problem-solving dreams," which left her feeling unrested when she woke up. "After I became a first-time mother, I quickly realized I was so busy caring for other people and work that I felt like I'd lost myself," shesaid.

C) It's a common story-one we frequently ridicule and readily dismiss, for example, by claiming that women tend to complain more than men, despite the growing sum of research that underlines the problem. Women are twice as likely to suffer from severe stress and anxiety as men, according to a 2016 study published in The Journal of Brain & Behavior. The American Psychological Association reports a gender gap year after year showing that women consistently report higher stress levels.Clearly, a stress gap exists.

D) "The difference is not really news to me, as a clinical psychologist," said Erin Joyce, a women and couples therapist in Los Angeles. "It's been well documented in extensive research over the years that prevalence rates for the majority of the anxiety disorders are higher in women than men." Some people may argue that this is merely reported data, and they say many men feel the same pressures as women in terms of fulfilling responsibilities at work and home. In other words, we're all really, really stressed.

E) "The difference, however, is in the nature and scope of these responsibilities in the home environment in particular," Dr. Joyce said. For example, the United Nations reported that women do nearly three times as much unpaid domestic work as men. The problem is, housework is often overlooked as work, even though it is often as laborious (or in some cases, more so) as any paid job. As the scholar Silvia Federici put it in 1975, the unpaid nature of domestic work reinforces the assumption that "housework is not work, thus preventing women from struggling against it."

F) It's not just inside the home, though. Research from Nova Southeastern University found that female managers were more likely than male managers to display "surface acting," or forcing emotions that are not wholly felt. "They expressed optimism, calmness

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and sympathy even when these were not the emotions that they were actually feeling," the study said.

G) Surface acting is a prime example of "emotional labor," a concept that the writer Jess Zimmerman made familiar in a 2015 essay. The essay sparked a massive thread on the internet community blog Meta Filter. Hundreds of women spoke up about their own experience with emotional labor; the duties that are expected of them, but go unnoticed. These invisible duties become apparent only when you don't do them. Like domestic labor, emotional labor is generally dismissed and not labeled work. But research shows it can be just as exhausting as paid work. Emotional labor can lead to difficulty in sleeping and family conflict. Sure, circumstantial stress, like losing a job, may lead to these same issues. But emotional labor is not circumstantial. It's an enduring responsibility based on the socialized gender role of women.

H) Like Ms. Li, many women try to manage the added stress to reach what Dr. Joyce said was an unattainable ideal. "Some professional women aim to do it all. They want to reach the top of the corporate ladder and fly like supermom," she said. When women don't reach this ideal, they feel guilty; and even more stressed. After her own struggle with this, Ms. Li took a step back and used her experience to build Sanity & Self, a self-care app and platform for overworked women. "The realizations I had in that process helped me gain insights and ultimately got me ready to integrate selfcare into my daily life," she said.

I) The stress problem extends beyond mental health when you consider the link between stress, anxiety and heart health. Worse, most of what we know about heart disease comes from studies involving men. However, "there are many reasons to think that it's different in women," Harvard Medical School reported. For example, women are more likely to experience disturbed sleep, anxiety and unusual fatigue before a heart attack. Stress is so normalized that it is easy for women to shrug off those symptoms as simply the consequences of stress. Many women also do not experience chest pain before a heart attack the way men do, which leads to fewer women discovering problematic heart issues. Harvard reports that women are "much more likely than men to die within a year of having a heart attack" and "many women say their physicians sometimes don't even recognize the symptoms."

J) The good news is, women are more likely than men to take charge of their stress and manage it, the American Psychological Association reports. The concept of self-care, at its

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core, is quite simple."The basics of adequate sleep, healthy diet and exercise are a good place to start," Dr. Joyce said."Support from trusted relationships is vital. This includes professional support from various health and wellness providers if stress is becoming increasingly overwhelming.”

K) Disconnecting from work and home responsibilities is also obviously important. But it's much easier said than done. It is important to understand what causes your stress in the first place. "Get really specific with what's stressing you out," Ms. Li said. "We often chalk up our stress to broad experiences like work. But work stress can take many different forms. Is a colleague being disrespectful of your time? Is a boss undermining your day-to-day control over decision making? These are different causes of stress and can benefit from different kinds of self-care."

L) Ideally, your spouse or partner will be supportive, rather than dismissive, of your stress. It is important to talk through these issues before they come to a head. "Women working outside of the home should make an effort to have a conscious conversation with their partners about more equitable sharing of household and family responsibilities," Dr. Joyce said.

36. Some career women who aim high tend to feel guilty if they fail to achieve their goals.

37. The unpaid housework done by women is triple that done by men.

38. It is reported that women consistently suffer more from severe stress than men.

39. Women are advised to identify the specific causes of their stress so that steps can be taken to deal with it.

40. One study showed that women managers often expressed positive emotions that they didn't really feel.

41. Women tend to mistake signs of heart attacks for symptoms of stress.

42. For a time an app developer in America was so busy attending to work and family that she suffered from sleeplessness.

43. The emotional labor women do is noticed only when it is not done.

44. Dr. Joyce suggests that apart from self-care, women should seek professional support if they experience severe stress

45. Some people believe that there may not exist a stress gap between men and women.

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阅读答案： H E C K J F I　B G J D

选词填空冲刺 1　答案见最后一页

The center of American automobile innovation has in the past decade moved 2,000 miles away. It has　26　from Detroit to Silicon Valley, where self-driving vehicles are coming into life.

In a　27　to take production back to Detroit, Michigan lawmakers have introduced　28　that could make their state the best place in the country, if not the world, to develop self-driving vehicles and put them on the road.

"Michigan's　29　in auto research and development is under attack from several states and countries which desire to　30　our leadership in transportation. We can't let happen," says Senator Mike Kowall, the lead　31　of four bills recently introduced.

If all four bills pass as written, they would　32　a substantial update of Michigan's 2013 law that allowed the testing of self-driving vehicles in limited conditions. Manufacturer would have nearly total freedom to test their self-driving technology on public roads. They would be allowed to send groups of self-driving cars on cross-state road trips, and even set on-demand　33　of self-driving cars, like the one General Motors and Lyft are building.

Lawmakers in Michigan clearly want to make the state ready for the commercial application of self-driving technology. In　34 , California, home of Silicon Valley, recently proposed far more 35　rules that would require human drivers be ready to take the wheel, and commercial use of self-driving technology.

A) bid	I) replace
B) contrast	J) represent
C) deputy	k) restrictive
D) dominance	L) reward
E) fleets	M) significant
F) knots	N) sponsor
G) legislation	O) transmitted
H) migrated	

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选词填空冲刺 2 答案见最后一页

Just because they can't sing opera or ride a bicycle doesn't mean that animals don't have culture. There's no better example of this than killer whales. As one of the most __26__ predators（食肉动物），killer whales may not fit the __27__ of a cultured creature. However, these beasts of the sea do display a vast range of highly __28__ behaviors that appear to be driving their genetic development.

The word "culture" comes from the Latin "colere," which __29__ means "to cultivate." In other words, it refers to anything that is __30__ or learnt, rather than instinctive or natural. Among human populations, culture not only affects the way we live, but also writes itself into our genes, affecting who we are. For instance, having spent many generations hunting the fat marine mammals of the Arctic, the Eskimos of Greenland have developed certain genetic __31__ that help them digest and utilize this fat-rich diet, thereby allowing them to __32__ in their cold climate.

Like humans, killer whales have colonized a range of different __33__ across the globe, occupying every ocean basin on the planet, with an empire that __34__ from pole to pole. As such, different populations of killer whales have had to learn different hunting techniques in order to gain the upper hand over their local prey（猎物）. This, in turn, has a major effect on their diet, leading scientists to __35__ that the ability to learn population-specific hunting methods could be driving the animals' genetic development.

A) acquired
B) adaptations
C) brutal
D) deliberately
E) expressed
F) extends
G) habitats
H) humble
I) image
J) literally
K) refined
L) revolves
M) speculate
N) structure
O) thrive

Questions 26 to 35 are based on the following passage. 答案见最后一页

When travelling overseas, do you buy water in plastic bottles or take your chances with tap water? Imagine you are

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wandering about on a Thai island or __26__ the ruins of Angkor. It's hot so you grab a bottle of water from a local vendor. It's the safe thing to do, right? The bottle is __27__, and the label says "pure water". But maybe what's inside is not so 28__. Would you still be drinking it if you knew that more than 90 percent of all bottled water sold around the world __29 microplastics?

That's the conclusion of a recently __30__ study, which analysed 259 bottles from 11 brands sold in nine countries, 31__ an average of 325 plastic particles per litre of water. These microplastics included a __32__ commonly known as PET and widely used in the manufacture of clothing and food and __33__ containers. The study was conducted at the State University of New York on behalf of Orb Media, a journalism organisation. About a million bottles are bought every minute, not only by thirsty tourists but also by many of the 2.1 billion worldwide who live with unsafe drinking water.

Confronted with this __34__, several bottled-water manufacturers including Nestle and Coca-Cola undertook their own studies using the same methodology. These studies showed that their water did contain microplastics, but far less than the Orb study suggested. Regardless, the World Health Organisation has launched a review into the __35__ health risks of drinking water from plastic bottles.

A) adequate	I) natural
B) admiring	J) potential
C) contains	K) released
D) defending	L) revealing
E) evidence	M) sealed
F) instant	N) solves
G) liquid	O) substance
H) modified	

26.H 27.A 28.G 29.D 30.I 31.N 32.J 33.E 34.B 35.K

26. C 27.I 28.K 29.J 30.A 31.B 32.O 33.G 34.F 35.M

26.B 27.M 28.I 29.C 30.K 31.L 32.O 33.G 34.E 35.J